

Reading a viz → **Build manually** → Build with AI → Write interpretation → AI interpretation → Spot disruption

Create your first visualization

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You're signed in and looking at your country's project
- ☐ You're in the **Visualizations** tab
- ☐ You have a folder of your own (or you can use the shared one)

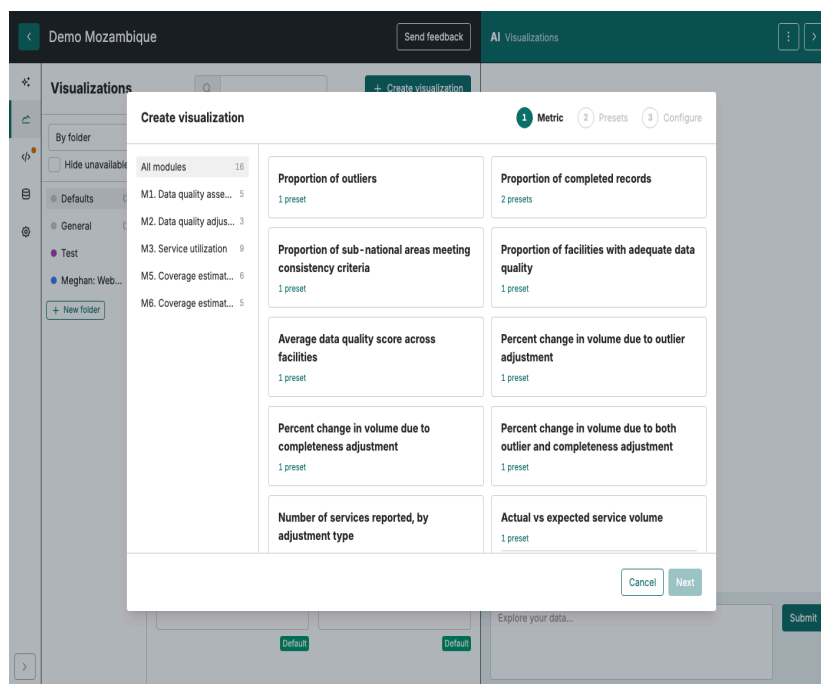
What you'll do

Build three time-series charts: first **ANCI**, then **BCG**, then **one indicator of your choice**. Each chart is saved into your folder in the project's Visualizations list. The next activity does the same task with the AI Assistant.

1 Open the Create visualization dialog

In the **Visualizations** tab, click the green **+ Create visualization** button in the top right.

A three-step dialog opens: **Metric** → **Presets** → **Configure**.



2 Pick a metric

In the left panel of the dialog, click **M3. Service utilization**. The grid on the right now lists only M3 metrics.

Click the tile **Number of services reported, by adjustment type**.

Click **Next** at the bottom right.

Metrics are grouped by module: **M1** (Data quality assessment), **M2** (Data quality adjustment), **M3** (Service utilization), **M5** (Coverage — denominators), **M6** (Coverage — estimates). There is no M4. A metric is *what is measured*. A preset is *one ready-made way to draw it*.

3 Pick a preset

You're now on the **Presets** step. Click **Service volume over time (monthly)** — a line chart of monthly volume.

The chart opens in the editor.

4 Filter to ANC1, last 12 months

The chart opens with all indicators shown across the full available time period. You'll narrow it to **ANC1, last 12 months**.

In the chart editor's **left panel**, scroll down to **Filter (subset)**:

- Under **Indicators**, tick **ANC1** only (untick the rest, or use the search box).
- Under **Time period**, set the range to the **last 12 months**.

The chart updates as you tick.

5 Save it to your folder

Click **Save as new viz** at the top of the editor. Give it a clear name (e.g. *ANC1 – monthly, last 12 months*) and save it into **your folder**.

It now appears in the Visualizations list under your folder.

Now do it twice more

Repeat the same five steps for:

1. **BCG** – same path, but tick **BCG** at Step 4 instead of ANC1.
2. **An indicator of your choice** – anything that interests you (Penta1, ANC4, IPD admissions...).

You should end up with **three saved charts in your folder**.

Filter vs disaggregate — what's the difference?

These two words come up a lot. They are not the same:

- **Filter = pick what to show.** Choose the indicators, places, or months you want — only those appear. e.g. *show ANC1 only*, or *Northern region only*. Like a spotlight: you point it at what you want to see.
- **Disaggregate = break it down.** Split one total into its parts so you can compare them — e.g. *one line per indicator*, or *one bar per district*. Nothing is hidden; the total is shown as its pieces.

FILTER = choose what to show

All indicators are available

☐ ANC1

☐ ANC4

☐ BCG

☐ Penta



You picked ANC1 → only ANC1 shows

☒ ANC1

☐ ANC4

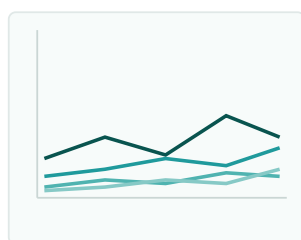
☐ BCG

☐ Penta

You pick what you want to see.

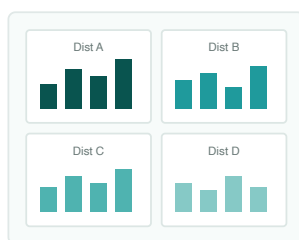
Whatever you don't tick simply isn't shown — like a spotlight.

DISAGGREGATE “ANC1 by district” — four ways to display the parts



Lines

one line per district



Grid

a mini chart for each

District	Visits
Dist A	900
Dist B	850
Dist C	1,000
Dist D	800

Rows

one row per district

Dist A	Dist B	Dist C	Dist D
900	850	1,000	800

Columns

one column per district

Example. Start with *total ANC1 visits, nationally*. **Filter** to "Northern region" → now you see only Northern's ANC1. **Disaggregate** "by district" → the same total split into one bar (or line) per district.

Where you do this when you edit a viz

Open a saved visualization — the controls live in the **left panel**, and you'll often need to **scroll down** to find them (this is where people get lost). Two sections do the work:

- **Filter (subset)** — **pick what you want to see**: set the time period, and tick the indicator(s) you want. Only what you tick appears.
- **Display (disaggregate)** — choose **how the parts are shown**. The dropdown gives four options:
 - **Lines** — one line per part, all on the same chart
 - **Grid** — a separate little chart for each part, side by side
 - **Rows** — one table row per part
 - **Columns** — one table column per part

Data	Presentation	Text
Metric Actual vs expected service volume		
Presentation type Timeseries		
Filter (subset) ☐ Data values ☒ Time period ☒ Last N months ☐ From specific month to present ☐ Last N full calendar years ☐ Last N full calendar quarters ☐ Custom Number of months = 12 ☒ Indicator ANC1 ANC4 BCG DELIVERY OPD PENTA1 PENTA3 PNC1_MOTHER PNC1_NEWBORN		
Display (disaggregate) ☒ Data values (Required for this visualization) Lines		

Watch out when you use both together. Here's the trap, with an example. You split a chart **by district** because you want to compare the districts. Then you **filter** it down to just one district — so the others disappear. Now you're looking at a single district on its own, and there's nothing left to compare.

The simple rule: use **filter** to pick the data you want to look at, and use **disaggregate** to split it into the parts you want to compare. Just don't filter down to only one of the things you wanted to compare.

Exercise: split your ANCI chart by region

Right now your ANCI chart shows one line: the national total over the last 12 months. You'll turn it into one line per **region** so you can compare regions side by side.

1 Open the chart

In the **Visualizations** list, open your saved ANCI chart (the one you named *ANCI – monthly, last 12 months*).

2 Disaggregate by region

In the chart editor's **left panel**, scroll down to **Display (disaggregate)**.

- Set the dimension to **Region** (the dropdown that asks *what to break the chart down by*).
- Leave the Display style on **Lines** for now — one line per region, all on the same chart.

The chart redraws. Instead of one national line, you should now see **one line per region**.

3 Try the other Display styles

Same data, different shape:

- **Grid** — a separate little chart per region, side by side. Useful when there are many regions and the lines overlap.
- **Rows** — a table with one row per region. Useful when you want the exact values rather than the shape.
- **Columns** — a table with one column per region.

Pick whichever reads best for your data.

4 Save it as a new chart

Click **Save as new viz** — name it e.g. *ANCI – monthly, by region* and save it into **your folder**.

Don't overwrite the national chart. Save *as new viz*, not just *save*, so you keep both: the national trend and the regional split.

Watch out

You set both Filter and Display in step 2 of the original walkthrough (filter to ANCI, last 12 months) and step 2 of this exercise (disaggregate by region). That's fine. The trap is **filtering down to one of the things you said you wanted to compare** — e.g. disaggregate by region *and then* filter to a single region. You'd be left with one line, nothing to compare.

Now do it for BCG

Repeat the same three steps on your saved BCG chart. You should end up with **two regional charts** in your folder: one for ANC1, one for BCG.

Try a few more options

Once your three charts are saved, try a different metric or preset:

- A coverage metric under **M6** (a coverage curve, not a volume trend).
- The quarterly-change bar chart preset (compares periods instead of plotting a continuous trend).

Tip: Line charts (*Service volume over time*) are best for trends over time. Bar charts (*quarterly / annual change*) are better for comparing periods or places. The reference handout *How to read a FASTR visualization* goes deeper.

Check yourself

You should now have:

- **Three saved charts** in your folder: ANC1, BCG, and one of your choice.
- The path memorised: **+ Create visualization → M3 → metric → preset → filter → Save as new viz.**
- A sense of which presets suit trends vs comparisons.

What's next

The next activity does the same thing using the AI Assistant — typing the request in plain language instead of clicking through the dialog. Same end result, different path.